

Information Cards — The Heavenly Crucifix

I1-I22 · Print double-sided · Cut along borders · Hand player-facing front to agents on discovery

SUPPORTING INTEL

I1

The Replacement

The crucifix on display at Prague Castle is a forgery — exceptional quality, correct weight, correct patina. But the iron is a modern alloy. Someone with metallurgical expertise and access to the original made a copy. The craftsmanship points to a Central European metalsmith with antiquities restoration experience — likely Austrian or southern German. The forgery was swapped within the last six weeks.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: I1 (Prague Castle), NPC3 (Reiner)

HQ Fallback: Day 8

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Examining the forgery with Tech or Lore (Diff 2) reveals the alloy discrepancy and the probable region of origin.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I2

When It Happened

The theft occurred on a Monday evening, approximately six weeks ago — the one night the museum closes early and the docents leave at 4 PM. The thief or thieves entered through a service door with a key. No forced entry. No alarms triggered. The forgery was placed in the display case the same night. The museum staff did not notice the substitution.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1 (Prague Castle), curator interview

HQ Fallback: Day 9

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The key implies inside information — someone knew the museum schedule and had access to the service door. The museum had six spare keys, distributed among staff and a cleaning contractor.

SUPPORTING INTEL

The Police Investigation

Inspector Radim Svoboda of the Czech Police has opened a theft investigation after museum staff finally noticed the substitution. His report notes: professional job, no forensic evidence, likely an international operation. He has requested cooperation from Interpol. Svoboda is methodical, unhurried, and competent — he may reach conclusions before the agents do.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1, O5M1 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 8

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Svoboda can be an ally or a complication. If agents share evidence with him, he provides police resources. If agents obstruct him, he investigates them too.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I4

The Martinice Family Tree

A hand-drawn family tree from Countess Martinice's papers. The crucifix is traced backward through seventeen generations, from the 1952 donation back to a marriage alliance in the 14th century. The earliest entry — before the Martinice line — reads: "Acquired from the Brothers of the Cross, Šumava, 12th century." Below that, in a different hand: "They found it in the forest. They should not have moved it."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L2 (Countess Martinice), NPC2
HQ Fallback: Day 7
Type: Supporting Intel
Notes: "Brothers of the Cross" refers to a monastic order that demolished the pagan shrine. The annotation "should not have moved it" is in the Countess's grandmother's handwriting.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I5

Where It Came From

The Countess's letters describe a location in the Šumava forest — "where the old ones marked the sky-fall." Directions are imprecise but triangulable: follow the Vydra River upstream from the old mill at Čeňkova Pila, past the split boulder, to a clearing where "the birds do not sing." The Countess visited once, in 1937, with her grandmother. She remembers the silence.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L2 (Countess Martinice), NPC2, NPC5 (Father Tomas has corroborating directions)

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Finding the shrine requires an Investigate (Diff 2) and a half-day hike. The site is L6.

I6

SUPPORTING INTEL

Not of This Earth

A letter from the Countess's great-grandfather, dated 1878, describing metallurgical tests he commissioned on the crucifix: "The iron does not match any known source in Bohemia. The nickel content is consistent with meteoric origin. The smith who examined it said it was 'not from here' and refused to work with it further. He would not say why. He returned the crucifix and would not accept payment. He died three months later in a foundry accident."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L2 (Countess Martinice), NPC2

HQ Fallback: Day 7

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This confirms the meteoric origin (CT-1). The smith's refusal and subsequent death are suggestive but not conclusive — agents may investigate the foundry accident further (dead end: it was genuinely an accident).

SUPPORTING INTEL

The Grandmother's Diary

Countess Martinice's grandmother wrote in 1908: "Took A. to the old place today. She is old enough to know. The iron is still there, under the circle of stones. I told her never to tell anyone — not the priests, not the government, not even her husband. This is not a Church matter. It never was. The sky sent it, and the forest keeps it. We only guard the one piece that was taken."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L2 (Countess Martinice), NPC2

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Confirms the shrine site contains additional iron fragments (CT-3). "A." is Alžběta, the current Countess, then age 13.

SUPPORTING INTEL

What Happened in Vienna

Dieter Heller, the antiques dealer, witnessed the test. Klaus Reiner stood in the back room of Heller's gallery, removed his shirt, and told Heller's security man to shoot him. Three shots, center mass, point-blank range. Reiner did not bleed. He did not fall. He laughed. He told Heller, "Now you know the price just went up." Heller has been unable to sleep since.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (Vienna gallery), NPC3 (Reiner), O2M1 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 7

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This confirms the crucifix's effect beyond doubt. Reiner's behavior post-test is the first sign of immortality mania.

SUPPORTING INTEL

Who Is Brokering the Sale

The Vantablack Compact is handling the transaction. Their broker is Elena Varga, a known figure in Central European underground antiquities. She operates out of Vienna and Zurich. The Compact is not acquiring the crucifix for its own use — they are brokering a private sale and taking a commission. The buyer's identity is being protected at the highest level of Compact operational security. Varga is the only person who knows who the buyer is.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (Vienna), NPC4 (Varga), O1M1 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This implicates the Compact (O2) and identifies Varga as the key to identifying the buyer.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I10

The Buyer — What Heller Overheard

Heller overheard Varga on the phone in his gallery: "Yes, he's American. Yes, you know who he is. No, I am not telling you over an open line. He wants it for personal reasons — he said something about not wanting to be shot again. I did not ask." The buyer is an American who survived a shooting. He is famous enough that Varga assumed her contact would recognize him from that description alone.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (Vienna), NPC4

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The "shot again" clue narrows the field considerably. Agents with Investigate or Lore (Diff 1) can compile a short list of famous Americans who survived assassination attempts. Warhol will be on it.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I11

Where It Was Stored

The crucifix was kept in safe deposit box 718 at the Bayerische Handelsbank in Munich for three days between the Vienna test and the Zurich meeting. The box was rented under the name "Schmidt" with forged Austrian identification. The bank manager, Vogel, remembers the renter: "A nervous man, kept touching his shirt collar. Paid in cash for three months. I told him we only rent by the year. He said three months would be enough."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L4 (Munich bank), O1 progression

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The box contains physical evidence of Reiner's stay (clothing, receipts, Varga's contact). Access requires the key (Reiner has it) or bank manager cooperation.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I12

The Thief Is Unraveling

Reiner's behavior is becoming erratic. He has been wearing the crucifix continuously for over two weeks. In Vienna, he challenged strangers to bar fights. In Munich, he walked into traffic to prove cars could not hurt him. The Compact is alarmed — Varga has privately described him as "a liability." Covenant psychoanalysts identify the pattern as "immortality mania": a documented psychological response to artifact-granted invincibility. The bearer will eventually attempt something the artifact cannot prevent.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O1M2 trigger, L3, L4, NPC4

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This confirms CT-2 indirectly — violence will not work, but Reiner's psychological state is a vulnerability that can be exploited.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I13

The Church's Mandate

Cardinal Voss is operating under a direct authorization from the Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith — the Vatican office that once oversaw the Inquisition. The authorization, dated three weeks ago, grants Voss "extraordinary discretion" in recovering the crucifix and explicitly states that "the pastoral value of the relic outweighs ordinary procedural constraints." In diplomatic language, Voss is authorized to do almost anything. The authorization was signed by a Cardinal whose name appears nowhere else in the case materials — a figure in the Vatican hierarchy who prefers to remain invisible.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O3M2 trigger, NPC1, NPC5

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This escalation means the Church team will not back down. Voss cannot be appealed to through ordinary channels — his authorization is effectively unlimited.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I14

The Airport Meeting

A meeting occurred at the Zurich private aviation terminal between Varga and an unidentified intermediary. Flight records show a Gulfstream III with a tail number registered to a Delaware holding company. The holding company traces to a New York art foundation. The intermediary was described by terminal staff as "a European woman, well-dressed, nervous, carrying a leather portfolio." No names were exchanged. The meeting lasted 40 minutes.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L5 (Zurich airport), L4 (Munich — travel itinerary), NPC4

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The Delaware holding company is the first link in the chain to Warhol. Agents with Investigate or Tech (Diff 2) can trace corporate registrations.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I15

The Gulfstream's Flight Plan

The Gulfstream III filed a flight plan from Teterboro Airport, New Jersey, to Zurich with no return date. The aircraft is owned by a holding company called "Silver Cloud Enterprises." Silver Cloud is a subsidiary of Warhol Enterprises, Inc. The flight plan lists one passenger: "A. Warhol." The intermediary booked the Zurich terminal lounge under her own name: Margot Lefèvre.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L5 (Zurich), O1M2 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 4

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This identifies Warhol by name if agents have traced the corporate chain. If they haven't, the flight plan is evidence but not proof. Lefevre (NPC7) can confirm.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I16

The Intermediary

Margot Lefèvre is a French art dealer specializing in "private acquisitions for discerning clients." She has represented Warhol in six previous purchases of unusual objects — occult texts, a purported alchemical manuscript, a reliquary. Her gallery is in the 6th arrondissement of Paris. She is not Covenant, not Compact, not Church. She is a civilian caught in something larger than she expected.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L5 (Zurich), NPC7, NPC4

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Lefèvre can be approached in Paris or at L5. She is the weakest link in the chain — frightened and carrying guilt.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I17

The Buyer

The buyer is Andy Warhol. The artist survived a near-fatal shooting by Valerie Solanas in 1968 — clinically dead for five minutes, revived after emergency surgery. He has spent eighteen years searching for a guarantee it will never happen again. Someone in his orbit — likely an art-world contact with underground connections — introduced him to the Compact. Warhol is not a criminal mastermind. He is a deeply frightened man with the resources to buy a solution to his fear. And someone sold him one.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O4M1 trigger, NPC7, I14+I15

HQ Fallback: Day 3

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This is the twist reveal. Play it quiet. The revelation that the buyer is Warhol should land as tragedy, not farce.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I18

More Iron Beneath the Stones

Excavation at the shrine site reveals additional fragments of meteoric iron beneath the foundation stones. The fragments are unworked — raw ore, dark with a high nickel content, cold to the touch. A metal detector returns strong signals across the clearing. The meteorite was not a single piece. It shattered on impact, scattering fragments across a roughly circular area 30 meters in diameter. The shrine was built to mark — and possibly to contain — the impact site. Each fragment, if forged and worn, would carry the same property as the crucifix.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L6 (shrine site), NPC5 (if present)
HQ Fallback: Day 3 (but HQ will demand agents seal the site before providing analysis)
Type: Supporting Intel (but directly supports CT-3)
Notes: This changes everything. The artifact is no longer unique — it is a raw material source. Containment now requires site-level protocols.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I19

The Shrine Builders

Among the shrine stones, agents find fragments of Slavic pagan ritual objects — a small iron amulet depicting Perun's axe, pottery shards with solar symbols, a fire pit lined with stones arranged in a radial pattern pointing outward from the impact center. Carbon dating of charcoal from the fire pit places the shrine's construction at approximately 900-950 CE. The builders were a Western Slavic community — likely the Dulebes or Lutici — who witnessed the meteorite impact and incorporated it into their religious practice. The shrine was active for approximately 150 years before Christianization reached the region.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L6 (shrine site), NPC5 (Father Tomas can identify the ritual objects)
HQ Fallback: Day 3
Type: Supporting Intel
Notes: This confirms CT-1 (pagan origin) beyond doubt. Father Tomas, if present, is visibly moved — this is the proof he has been seeking.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I20

Eyes in the Forest

Agents detect signs of recent surveillance near the shrine site: fresh cigarette butts (Soviet brand: Belomorkanal), a discarded film canister, boot prints consistent with Soviet military footwear. A KGB Vienna station has identified the Compact's money trail and connected it to the Prague theft. A two-man surveillance team is operating in the Šumava region. They do not yet know the significance of the shrine site — they are following the agents. But if the agents lead them to the meteorite fragments, Soviet Intelligence will have everything they need to launch their own recovery operation.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O6M1 trigger, L6

HQ Fallback: Day 3

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The KGB team is a complication, not a combat encounter. They are surveillance, not assault. If agents detect them (Investigate Diff 2), they can be evaded, fed false information, or — with extreme care — turned into unwitting assets.

SUPPORTING INTEL

I21

Why Him

Warhol told an interviewer in 1985: "I don't believe in death. I don't believe in it because you're not around to know you've had it." On June 3, 1968, Valerie Solanas shot him three times. The first bullet passed through his left lung, his spleen, his stomach, his liver, and his right lung. The second entered his right abdomen. The third was stopped by his spine. He was declared clinically dead at 4:51 PM. Surgeons opened his chest and massaged his heart until it restarted. He spent two months in the hospital. He wore a surgical corset for the rest of his life. He never stopped waiting for her to come back. The crucifix is not a purchase. It is an end to an eighteen-year panic attack.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O4M2 trigger, NPC7, NPC8

HQ Fallback: Day 2

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This card should be given to players when they learn Warhol's full story — either from Lefèvre, from Warhol himself, or from HQ research after his identity is known. The emotional weight of this card should land hard.

CONTAINMENT TRUTH — SYNTHESIS

What This Has Always Been About

The Crucifix of St. Vitus is not a Christian relic. It is forged from meteoric iron that fell on the Bohemian Forest in approximately 900 CE. The pagan community that witnessed the impact built a shrine and venerated the iron as a fragment of their sky-god's armor. When the Church arrived, the shrine was destroyed, the iron was reforged into a crucifix, and the origin was suppressed — a secret maintained by the Martinice family and the Vatican's own archives for a thousand years. The iron grants immunity to bodily harm because it is not from Earth. There is more iron at the shrine site. The artifact is replicable. If the Church reclaims it, they face a theological crisis. If the Soviets find the shrine, they gain a strategic material. If Warhol buys it, he wears it until it kills him. The Covenant's mandate is clear: contain the crucifix, seal the shrine, and let no one — not the Church, not the Compact, not the KGB, not a frightened artist — turn this into something worse.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: All. This is the synthesis card — given to agents when they have assembled the full picture, typically at L7 or after the climax.

HQ Fallback: N/A — cannot be provided by HQ. Must be assembled by agents.

Type: Containment Truth (synthesis of CT-1, CT-2, CT-3)

Notes: This card represents the moment the agents understand the case completely. Award it at the climax or during the Aftermath debrief. It is the answer to "what was this really about?"